

Week 1.1

Course introduction

About the instructor

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From Toronto, Canada

Work experience in Canada, the UK, Russia, Ukraine, and Uzbekistan

Advanced degrees from the University of Toronto (Canada), the Moscow State Institute of International Relations (Moscow), The University of Reading (UK), and Webster University in Tashkent (US/Uzbekistan)

About the course

Introduction to academic English

Emphasis on speaking and listening

Intended to support your other studies

Getting to know you



Questions?

Let's get to work!

Work in pairs. Identify each type of group in the photos and any similar groups you belong to.



Discussion

Think about each group you belong to and how important that group is to your identity. Choose the two groups you think have the biggest influence on your identity. Then compare with your partner and explain the difference.

The following factors can all influence our personal identity. Number them 1-8 in order of importance to your identity, with 1 being most important and 8 being least.

- clothes
- friends
- values
- language
- studies
- interests
- family
- job

Listening for key ideas

Listen to the first part of a podcast interview with a Scottish man who has moved to Japan. Circle the things in the list from the previous exercise that he says were important for his sense of identity in the past. Does he mention anything that is not on the list?



Listening for meaning

Listen to the second part of the interview and answer these questions:

1. In general, how does Dylan feel he's changed since moved to Nagoya?
2. Which specific factors in his sense of identity have changed? Why?



Match the phrases (1-6) to the definitions (a-f).

1. family values	a. the kind of family you come from
2. sense of identity	b. the things you hope to achieve in the future
3. social status	c. beliefs that you learn from your family
4. family background	d. position in society; class
5. life goals	e. your friends
6. social group	f. the feeling of who you are

Match the phrases (1-6) to the definitions (a-f).

1. family values - beliefs that you learn from your family
2. sense of identity - the feeling of who you are
3. social status - position in society; class
4. family background - the kind of family you come from
5. life goals - the things you hope to achieve in the future
6. social group - your friends

Work in groups. Ask and answer the questions.

1. Is family background important to your sense of identity? Which family values are important to you?
2. What's the difference between family background and social status? How might they be related to each other?
3. Do you and the people in your social group share the same life goals? Is that important?

Listen to a part of a seminar on identity. What does Sean think about expressing personal identity?



Work in pairs. Listen again and complete the phrases from the conversation then compare your answers with another pair. Which phrases are used to agree, partially agree, or disagree?

1. Well, yes, to a _____ extent...
2. _____ and no.
3. I'm _____, but I just don't think that's true.
4. I'm _____ I can't agree.
5. In a _____, you're right, but...
6. I _____ agree more.



In small groups, discuss the following question:

Do you think it is important to 'be yourself' at all times, even if sometimes it may upset people?

Join the group Telegram chat

